

	Case Name: Commercial IT Project	Sector	IT (Software Development)	
	OR-AS Operations Research - Applications and Solutions www.or-as.be info@or-as.be	Baseline Schedule	Schedule with resources	
			Schedule with costs	
		Risk Analysis	Random simulation	
Submitted by	Simon Buysse		One of nine std. scenarios	
Date	2011		User defined distributions	
File Name	C2011-09 Commercial IT Project	Project Control	Automatic tracking	
			Tracking based on user input	

1. Project description

Project authenticity

The complete developing process of a software program for magazine publishers, including a preliminary market analysis.

The project consists of activity, resource and cost data that were created by the user

2. Project properties

2.1. Baseline Schedule

General		Network topology	
# Activities	41	Serial/Parallel (SP)	55%
Planned Duration (PD)	66d 5h	Activity Distribution (AD)	49%
Budget At Completion (BAC)	33.623 €	Length of Arcs (LA)	20%
Renewable Resources	8	Topological Float (TF)	24%
Consumable Resources	-		

* standard eight-hour working days

2.2. Risk Analysis

Random simulation by ProTrack was performed using the default symmetric triangular risk distribution profiles.

	Cost sensitivity		
	avg [%]	std dev [%]	skew [-]
CRI-r	11.4	14.3	2.2
CRI-rho	21.5	19.4	0.8
CRI-tau	32.6	35.7	1.2

	Time sensitivity		
	avg [%]	std dev [%]	skew [-]
CI	2.44	10.23	4.86
SI	22.90	19.39	1.19
SSI	0.58	2.43	4.81
CRI-r	11.27	14.43	2.90
CRI-rho	14.69	17.28	1.93
CRI-tau	20.92	26.76	2.00

	Resource sensitivity		
	avg [%]	std dev [%]	skew [-]
CRI-r	39.05	9.89	-1.35
CRI-rho	39.05	9.89	-1.35
CRI-tau	39.05	9.89	-1.35

2.3. Project Control

2.3.1. Simulated forecasting accuracy

The accuracy of time and cost forecasting methods has been evaluated based on Monte Carlo simulation runs using the risk profiles described in section “2.2. Risk Analysis”. Based on these risk profiles, the Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE) and Mean Percentage Error (MPE) has been calculated to evaluate the expected accuracy of the time and cost predictions, EAC(t) and EAC, respectively.

Simulated EAC(t) accuracy		
method - PF	MAPE [%]	MPE [%]
PV - 1	2.30	0.75
PV - SPI	3.52	0.87
PV - SCI	3.65	0.99
ED - 1	3.06	1.56
ED - SPI	3.44	0.79
ED - SCI	3.46	0.81
ES - 1	4.08	-2.89
ES - SPI(t)	24.57	-22.51
ES - SCI(t)	24.58	-22.50

Simulated EAC accuracy		
method (PF)	MAPE [%]	MPE [%]
1	0.7	-0.3
CPI	0.7	-0.3
SPI	2.0	-0.2
SPI(t)	20.9	-19.7
SCI	2.0	-0.2
SCI(t)	20.9	-19.7
0.8 CPI + 0.2 SPI	0.9	-0.1
0.8 CPI + 0.2 SPI(t)	2.7	-2.3

According to the MAPE values¹ the best performance for time forecasting can be expected from the unweighted PV method. For cost forecasting the unweighted and CPI-weighted methods should yield the best results.

2.3.2. Tracking description

The user has not performed any project control and therefore no tracking periods have been defined. Tracking periods can now be generated automatically by ProTrack or by manually inputting tracking data period by period..

¹ The MAPE gives the best indication for the forecast accuracy (the lower the MAPE, the more accurate the method) since all deviations from the targeted real duration (real cost) are cumulated, whereas for the MPE underestimates can be compensated by overestimates and vice versa, possibly leading to an overly positive evaluation of a certain method. However, the MPE can provide useful information about the nature of the deviations, i.e. does the method rather underestimate or overestimate the real duration (real cost)